

Date: May 15, 2026

Dr. Xi Gong
Department of Biobehavioral Health
The Pennsylvania State University
University Park, PA
Dear Dr. Gong and Search Committee,

I am applying for the Postdoctoral Scholar position in the Environmental Health and Geospatial Data Science Lab at Penn State. With a PhD in Geography & Environmental Studies from Addis Ababa University and over a decade of experience in geospatial analysis, climate–health linkages, and disease burden research, I bring an interdisciplinary background that directly supports the Gong Lab’s mission to advance environmental exposure modeling and spatiotemporal analytics. At the Ethiopian Public Health Institute, I researched on disease burden and health economic evaluation, integrating geospatial methods to inform national policy. My publications in *Regional Environmental Change*, *Tropical Medicine and Health*, and *BMC Public Health* etc. demonstrate my ability to apply spatial modeling and multilevel analysis to pressing public health challenges. These experiences have strengthened my expertise in GIS platforms and statistical tools, while preparing me to contribute to advanced exposure modeling and visualization at Penn State. Beyond technical skills, I bring a strong commitment to collaboration, mentorship, and scientific communication, developed through my work as Assistant Professor at Madda Walabu University and researcher currently at Ethiopian Public Health Institute. I am eager to contribute to the Gong Lab’s interdisciplinary agenda and advance impactful research in environmental health science. Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my background and research vision can support your team’s goals.

Sincerely,
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